

BOB INGRAM

Henson, Aggies, Bob, Chuck, Earl



DEVANEY

THE GOOD BOOK says that the sins of the father are visited upon the children "unto the third and fourth generations."

Lou Henson, getting ready to start basketball practice at Illinois, has been taking some raps over some football scheduling he did while he was athletic director at New Mexico State.

The Aggies went up to Lincoln, Nebr., Saturday and lost to the Cornhuskers 57-0. "Don't blame us," present Aggie athletic department people are saying. "Henson scheduled us against Nebraska." It might be pointed out, too, that cool culprit Lou scheduled more games with Nebraska—in 1982 and 1985—and that he booked Arkansas and Iowa State in the future.

As the "father" who "sinned," Lou may be taking some criticism he doesn't deserve. I think he should be praised, in fact, for wheeling and dealing in his football scheduling.

Some people think that playing with and against the best is beneficial even though the best may be too good. And those Aggies going to Lincoln, playing in the huge Nebraska stadium before a red sea of nearly 77,000 Nebraska fans is an experience that will be unforgettable. They can tell their grandchildren that they played in the big time.

Besides Nebraska players are human even if they may be faster and bigger than the Aggies. And even if there are more of them.

In 1971, Nebraska's national champion team defeated Army at West Point by a score of 77-7. That game was on national TV. Bob Devaney, the Husker coach, didn't try to run up the score. He couldn't prevent the debacle and the humiliation to one of our branches of the armed forces. You had to think that if our military fought like they played football, our country was in bad shape.

The Aggies don't have to be ashamed despite the fact, as Russell Letz of KTSM says, "the game wasn't as close as the score indicated."

JIM THOMAS of The Herald-Post talked to Devaney at the Nebraska game. Devaney is now the athletic director of the school. He brought Wyoming to the Sun Bowl when he was coach of the Cowboys and in 1969 brought his Huskers here. They defeated Georgia 45-6 which, on a comparative basis, was as bad as them whipping the Aggies last Saturday.

Devaney told our man Jim that "we really enjoyed our trip to the Sun Bowl. The people treated us well and our players enjoyed the El Paso hospitality."

Devaney was interested in the campaign to enlarge the Sun Bowl. It indicated that he might be lured back here some day if the stadium was big enough to accommodate all those thousands of Husker fans who go everywhere the team travels and other fans.

But Devaney made it plain that he was more interested in playing in the Orange Bowl which is committed to taking the Big Eight champion each year.

As for building plans, Devaney has some of his own. The Nebraska stadium likely will be enlarged so that it will seat 100,000.

TWO VIBRANT managers head the teams in the World Series which opens tonight.

They are well turned out and well matured. Chuck Tanner of the Pirates is 50.

Earl Weaver of the Orioles is 49. It might be a good age for big league managers.

El Paso knew Tanner well since he was manager of El Paso Sun Kings in 1965, 1966 and 1968. El Paso was the first Class AA club the expansionist California Angels had. And the players they sent here in 1965 weren't up to Texas League standards. Chuck struggled to win some respectability with that team. He had a better team in 1966 and in 1968 brought a championship team to El Paso. The Kings beat Arkansas Travs in the playoff.

The two managers have contrasting backgrounds. Chuck was a good hitting outfielder who played eight years in the majors on four different clubs. Bad legs forced him to end his big league career before old age got him.

He had one distinguishing achievement. In his first appearance at bat in a major league game, he hit a home run.

Weaver made one brief El Paso appearance. At the invitation of the man who managed him in Denver and New Orleans, Andy Cohen, Earl spoke at a Mount Sinai Sportsman-of-The-Year dinner.

He never made it to the big leagues but had a long minor league career as a secon baseman. He came up to the Orioles through the Baltimore organization.

He's described as being firey, brash and feisty. He may not win many popularity polls among his players but he holds their respect.

Tanner may have more charisma among his players. But he can be tough and demanding. I've seen him display hardness that a manager needs.

Weaver is described as a Houdini. He's considered one of the smartest managers in the big league. After managing the Chicago White Sox, Oakland A's and after piloting Pittsburgh to a World Series, Tanner has shown he has a good supply of brain cells, too.

In the last World Series he played in, Weaver got thrown out on his ear by one of the umpires. And that is a rare feat. Managers have to say and do a lot before they are chased in the World Series.

It's going to be an interesting series and watching Tanner and Weaver operate and pull their strategy strings will help build up the drama.